WAR OF THE LEAGUE OF CAMBRAI

BREST



Date August 10, 1512
Forces English: 25 ships; French: 22 ships
Losses English: 1 ship; French: 2 ships

Location Off Brest, Brittany, France

In 1512 England went to war with France. Edward Howard took a fleet to sea and harassed French shipping. To put a stop to these depredations, Louis XII ordered a fleet to be assembled at Brest under Vice Admiral René de Clermont.

On August 10 the English surprised the French at anchor off the Pointe de St Mathieu. Many Breton gentry were on board the ships to celebrate the Feast of St Lawrence. The French cut their cables and many fled for the safety of the Brest roadstead. De Clermont's flagship was assailed by Howard aboard the newly commissioned *Mary Rose* and had his mainmast shot away before drifting out of the battle. The largest English ship, the 1,000-ton *Regent*, commanded by Sir Thomas Knyvet, grappled *Cordelière*, whose captain Primauget was a noted Breton seaman. Knyvet was cut in two by a cannonball, but *Cordelière* seemed sure to be taken when it exploded, destroying both ships and killing more than a thousand men. Despite the loss of *Regent*, it was a clear English victory. In reward, King Henry VIII appointed Howard Admiral of England.

THE BATTLE OF THE SOLENT

In 1543 English king Henry VIII went to war with France as an ally of Emperor Charles V. After the English seized Boulogne, French king François I planned an invasion of England. He assembled a fleet at Le Havre in the summer of 1545, bringing 25 Mediterranean galleys north to join his Channel ships. In June English admiral John Dudley led an attempted pre-emptive strike against the French invasion fleet but failed to do significant damage. Dudley arrived back at Portsmouth on July 13 with his ships in need of resupply and repair. The English fleet was far from ready when the French invasion force arrived.

WARS OF FRANÇOIS I & CHARLES V



THE BATTLE OF THE SOLENT

Date	July 10-15,1545
Location	Solent, off Portsmouth, southern England
Result	Inconclusive battle

COMBATANTS

ENGLAND	FRANCE

COMMANDERS

Admiral John Dudley	Admiral Claude d'Annebault

FORCES

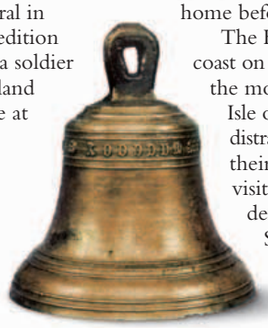
Ships: 80	**Ships:** 150 sailing ships, 25 galleys

LOSSES

Men: unknown **Ships:** unknown	**Men:** unknown **Ships:** unknown

AN INAUSPICIOUS START

The man appointed admiral in charge of the French expedition was Claude d'Annebault, a soldier with great experience of land warfare but no experience at sea. He suffered an early setback when his flagship *Carraquon* caught fire before leaving harbor and had to be abandoned. He then shifted his flag to *La Grande Maîtresse*, which subsequently ran aground as the invasion fleet left the French coast on July 15. The *Maîtresse* continued across the Channel but was shipping water, and had to be sent home before battle was joined.



Relics of the Mary Rose
Among the nautical instruments found in the wreck of the *Mary Rose* were this wooden compass dial and a pair of dividers.

The French reached the Sussex coast on 18 July and sailed west to the mouth of the Solent, off the Isle of Wight. The English were distracted by the presence of their king, who had come to visit his fleet and inspect the defenses of Portsmouth. Sunday, 19 July was a fine, still day. With sailing ships becalmed, some

> "WHEN SHE HEELED OVER WITH THE WIND, THE WATER ENTERED BY THE LOWEST ROW OF GUN PORTS WHICH HAD BEEN LEFT OPEN AFTER FIRING."
>
> **VAN DER DELFT,** IMPERIAL AMBASSADOR, REPORTING THE ACCOUNT OF A SURVIVOR FROM THE *MARY ROSE*

